

AIF-C01: 7-Day Study Plan

PLAN A: 7-DAY CRASH PLAN

Assumptions

- Your exam is 7 days away or fewer.
- You can commit 2 to 3 focused hours per day.
- The goal is broad coverage and exam-day confidence, not mastery of every nuance. You will prioritize the highest-priority terms and AWS services and accept that you will not memorize everything.

Plan A Schedule at a Glance

Day	Theme	Time Budget	Key Materials	New / Review Flashcards	Practice Questions
1	Domain 1: AI and ML Fundamentals	2.5-3 hrs	Domain 1 Study Module (all sections); AWS Services Quick Reference Guide (Machine Learning section only)	25 new / 0 review	10 (Domain 1 bank)
2	Domain 2: Fundamentals of GenAI	2.5-3 hrs	Domain 2 Study Module (all sections)	25 new / 10 review	12 (Domain 2 bank)
3	Domain 3, Part 1: Prompt Engineering and RAG	2.5-3 hrs	Domain 3 Study Module, Task Statement 3.1 (RAG, vector databases) and 3.2 (prompt engineering)	25 new / 15 review	7 (Domain 3 bank, prompt/RAG items)
4	Domain 3, Part 2: Model Selection, Fine-Tuning, and Evaluation	2.5-3 hrs	Domain 3 Study Module, Task Statement 3.1 (FM selection, customization tradeoffs, agents), 3.3, and 3.4	25 new / 20 review	7 (remaining Domain 3 bank)

Day	Theme	Time Budget	Key Materials	New / Review Flashcards	Practice Questions
5	Domains 4 and 5 Combined	3 hrs	Domain 4 Study Module and Domain 5 Study Module (all sections)	30 new / 25 review	7 + 7 (Domain 4 and 5 banks)
6	Full Practice Exam and Service Review	2.5-3 hrs	Full-Length Practice Exam (timed, 90 minutes); AWS Services Quick Reference Guide (full read); Answer Key and Rationale Guide	0 new / 40 review	65 (the full exam)
7	Exam Day Prep	1.5-2 hrs (light)	Visual Cheat Sheet (two full reads); weakest-domain Study Module section; weak-area flashcards only	0 new / weak-area deck only	10-15 (weakest domain only)

Day-by-Day Details

Day 1: Domain 1, Fundamentals of AI and ML The one concept to own today: The difference between supervised learning, unsupervised learning, and reinforcement learning, and which AI/ML technique (classification, regression, or clustering) fits which kind of business problem.

End-of-day self-check: 1. Can I define AI, ML, deep learning, and inferencing in one plain-English sentence each, without circling back to jargon? 2. Given a short business scenario, can I say with confidence whether it calls for classification, regression, or clustering?

Tonight's 5-minute review: Re-read the Domain Summary Table near the start of the Master Blueprint and the one-line "Plain-English Focus" description for Domain 1.

Day 2: Domain 2, Fundamentals of GenAI The one concept to own today: What a token, an embedding, and a context window are, and why hallucination is the single most important limitation of generative AI to understand for this exam.

End-of-day self-check: 1. Can I explain a token, an embedding, and a context window using an everyday analogy (not the technical definition)? 2. Can I name three business advantages and three business risks of using GenAI?

Tonight's 5-minute review: Recite, from memory, the advantages and disadvantages of GenAI for business use covered in Task Statement 2.2.

Day 3: Domain 3, Part 1: Prompt Engineering and RAG **The one concept to own today:** Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG) lets a model answer using your company's own documents without retraining the model, and the four prompt engineering techniques (zero-shot, single-shot, few-shot, chain-of-thought) differ by how many examples you give the model.

End-of-day self-check: 1. Can I explain RAG to a non-technical colleague using a simple analogy, such as a researcher who checks a reference library before answering a question? 2. Can I name the four AWS services that can store vector embeddings for RAG (Amazon OpenSearch Service, Amazon Aurora, Amazon Neptune, and Amazon RDS for PostgreSQL with pgvector)?

Tonight's 5-minute review: Read the four prompt-engineering technique definitions one more time, out loud if possible.

Day 4: Domain 3, Part 2: Model Selection, Fine-Tuning, and Evaluation **The one concept to own today:** The customization spectrum, from cheapest and fastest to most expensive and slowest: prompt engineering, RAG, fine-tuning, model distillation, and pre-training from scratch. Also: which evaluation metric goes with which task (ROUGE for summarization, BLEU for translation, LLM-as-a-judge for general quality checks).

End-of-day self-check: 1. Can I rank the FM customization approaches from lowest to highest cost and complexity? 2. Can I say which evaluation metric applies to summarization, which applies to translation, and what LLM-as-a-judge means?

Tonight's 5-minute review: Walk through the FM customization cost ladder one more time, from prompt engineering up to pre-training.

Day 5: Domains 4 and 5 Combined **The one concept to own today:** The six features of responsible AI (bias, fairness, inclusivity, robustness, safety, veracity), and the difference between what AWS CloudTrail records, what Amazon CloudWatch monitors, and what AWS Config tracks.

End-of-day self-check: 1. Can I name all six responsible AI features and connect at least one AWS tool to each? 2. Can I explain, in one sentence, what AWS is responsible for versus what the customer is responsible for when using a service like Amazon Bedrock?

Tonight's 5-minute review: Re-read the CloudTrail-versus-CloudWatch-versus-Config comparison in the Domain 5 Study Module or the AWS Services Quick Reference Guide.

Day 6: Full Practice Exam and Service Review **The one concept to own today:** Exam pacing. With 65 questions in 90 minutes, you have roughly 80 seconds per question on average. If a question is taking too long, flag it, make your best guess, and move on.

End-of-day self-check: 1. Did I finish the practice exam with at least 5 minutes left over to revisit flagged questions? 2. Which single domain produced the most missed questions for me, and do I understand why?

Tonight's 5-minute review: Before bed, read the rationale for every question you missed on the practice exam, once each, using the Answer Key and Rationale Guide. Do not study any new material tonight.

Day 7: Exam Day Prep The one concept to own today: There is no new material today. The only job today is to consolidate what you already know and walk in calm.

End-of-day self-check: 1. Can I name my weakest domain and the three concepts within it that worried me most, and have I now reviewed each of them at least once? 2. Do I know my exam-day logistics (ID requirements, online proctoring equipment check, or testing center arrival time)?

Tonight's 5-minute review: Read the Visual Cheat Sheet once, completely, then close your study materials and rest. Do not cram further.
